

Hazrat Ilyaaṣ ﷺ

Ilyaaṣ ﷺ in the Qur'ān

In the Qur'ān Hazrat Ilyaaṣ ﷺ is mentioned twice once in *Surah An'aam* and again in *Surah Saffaat*. In *An'aam* his name is only mentioned as him being one of the Prophets and in *Saffaat* there is somewhat more detailed description of his mission. As far as his mission is concerned the *Mufasssireen* and the historians are of the opinion that he was sent to the people of *Shaam* (Syria) for their guidance and the centre of his mission was in the wellknown city of *Ba'labak*.

The people of *Balabak* were idol-worshipper who worshipped the god Ba'al and were far removed in their belief from the Oneness of God. According to the *Mufasssireen* this god Baal was made out of gold, twenty feet high. He had four faces and four hundred servants were at all times at his service.

The people of Hazrat Ilyaaṣ ﷺ apart from other idols, had a special worship for this idol.

The Qur'ān states: "So also was Ilyaaṣ among those sent by us. Behold he said to his people: "Will you not fear Allah?"

Will you call upon Baal and for sake the best of Creator?

Allah, your Lord and cherisher. And the Lord and cherisher of your fore fathers.

But they rejected him and they not certainly be called up for punishment.

Except the sincere and devoted servants of Allah." (37:123—128)

Admonition

In spite of the story of Hazrat Ilyas  being mentioned in the Qur'ān¹ so concisely, yet this lesson comes through quite clearly: the mental make-up of Bani Israel had become so changed for the worse that there was no evil in this world which they were not keen to proform and there was no virtue which they intended to strove for. In spite of the continuous and successive appearance of Prophets and messengers they still held onto idol-worship, and worship of the heavenly bodies. In fact there was not a form of polytheism which they did not follow at some time or another.

In the Qur'ān where it mentions the various incidents about Bani Israel and their unfortunate wretchedness and perverseness, we are at the same time admonished that now that the chain of Prophet hood has been terminated and now that the arrival of the Last Prophet  had put an end to all that with the final Divine message, it is of the atmost importance not to follow Bani Israel and adopt their perverse nature and mental make-up. It is a lesson for us to steadfastly hold onto Allah's commands and not to adopt any crookedness and disobey Him.

Note: In the Book of John in the Bible Nabi Ilyas  is called Elijah.

Hazrat Al-Yasa' عليه السلام

According to History Hazrat Al-Yasa' عليه السلام is the cousin of Nabi Ilyas عليه السلام. He was also his vice and successor. During the early part of his life he used to be in the company of Hazrat Ilyas عليه السلام. After the demise of Nabi Ilyas عليه السلام Allah appointed him as a Nabi for the guidance of Bani Israel. He continued to guide Bani Israel in the same way that Hazrat Ilyas عليه السلام did.

Mention of Al-Yasa' in the Qur'ān

Hazrat Al-Yasa' عليه السلام is only mentioned twice in the Qur'ān.

1. "And Ismael عليه السلام, Al-Yasa' عليه السلام, Yunus عليه السلام and Loot عليه السلام.
And to all (of them) we gave favour above the nations."
(6:86)
2. "And remember Ismael عليه السلام, Al-Yasa' عليه السلام and Zulkifl عليه السلام.
Each of them was of the Company of good."

Lesson: Among Bani Israel there were quite a few cases where one Nabi stayed in the company of another and was later appointed to the same office. From this we deduce that the company of the pious is a sure means towards getting to righteousness.

"A short while in the company of the saintly is better than a hundred years of obedience."

QASASUL AMBIYAA

STORIES OF THE PROPHETS

Maulana Hifzur Rahman Seoharwy (Rah.)



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Qasasul Ambiyaa

(Stories of the Prophets)

By: Maulana Hifzur Rahman Seoharwy (Ra)

Translated by: Maulana Yusuf Karaan



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D-80, Abul Fazal Enclave-I, Jamia Nagar
New Delhi-110 025 (India)

Tel.: +91-11-2695 6832 & 085888 33786

Fax: +91-11-6617 3545 Email: sales@idara.co

Online Store: www.idarastore.com

Retail Shop: **IDARA IMPEX**

Shop 6, Nizamia Complex, Gali Gadrian, Hazrat Nizamuddin
New Delhi-110013 (India) Tel.: 085888 44786

Qasasul Ambiyaa

The Holy Qur'ān does not relate historical facts merely for the sake of telling a story which is of historical value. Its main aim in relating happenings is to draw attention to the results, conclusions and deductions from these incidents so that they become a source of guidance for men and prove to be lessons for them that appeal to their minds and emotions that from these historical events, lessons should be derived. These lessons should convince them that the existence of Allah is an undeniable fact and that His Mighty Hand is playing a major role in the affairs of men. It should also bring to their notice that to follow the stipulations of His deen brings success and leads to salvation and is the way towards all progress. That is what Islām—the natural religion—is about.

From: Qasasul Qur'ān

Preface

The most authentic and comprehensive work of Maulana Hifzur Rahman Seoharwy, *Qasasul Qur'ān* needs no introduction. However, the Manner in which our friend Sayed Tanzeem Hussain Saheb has brought forth an abridged version of a voluminous and bulky work he has undoubtedly, fulfilled one of the needs of this time. He has adopted such a method of abridgement whereby not only has he retained and mentioned every important fact in the lives of the Holy Prophets (*Alaihimus Salām*) and other saintly personalities, which are of lessons to men, but also discussed in brought outline some other important matters. It is hoped that with Allah's grace, those persons who are occupied and busy at all times, will be able to derive adequate benefit from this work.

The great effort of Sayed Tanzeem Hussain in this old age of his is really something praiseworthy. May Allah reward him well for this great effort.

Qari Sayed Rasheedul-Hasan Hussainy Nadwi

Imam and Khateeb

Jama Masjid, New Town

Allamah Binori Town, Karachi

P5 Muharram, 1308 Hijri

Publisher's Foreword

The respected personality of Maulana Hifzur Rahman Seoharwy is one of the most eminent Ulama of the Indo-Pak Sub-Continent. His most approved and well-known book, *Qasasul-Qur'ān* is considered to be a unique publication on this subject. The point that distinguishes it from other similar books is the fact that after every story, Maulana has made use of deep thought and reflection to present to the readers the lessons and points of guidance from the related episodes. Thus for the teachers and lecturers at *Deeni Madressas* and for preachers in mosques and students of deen the study and perusal of this book is of utmost benefit.

The original book appeared in four volumes with over 1800 pages of subject matter. Sayed Tanzeem Hussain Saheb has brought forth an abridged version there of in only 600 pages and this has been met with a verdict of approval from all academic circles, especially by virtue of the fact that he has fulfilled one of the most pressing needs of the time and by leaving aside unimportant discussions have given the busy and occupied ones also a chance to benefit from these work. May Allah reward him well.

Author's Foreword

All praise be to Allah who has guided us with the Holy Book and revealed to us the Qur'ān in a clear Arabic language and in it. He related the best of stories as an admonition and a reminder for the believers. And May peace and blessings be upon the Most truthful and trustworthy Prophet Muhammad ﷺ, the messenger of Allah and seal of all the Prophets and upon his offspring, and companions who were all of them guiding stars for all the righteous ones.

Among the inimitable ways in which Allah has chosen for the sake of the guidance of men, is this that attention is drawn to the good and bad deeds of nations and the resultant fruits of such deeds of which they are reminded so that those deeds may be a lesson for men. For this reason those stories are not being related in a style as is generally done in history. The major aim is to convey the truth and to invite to Allah and with this in mind attention is only drawn to those aspects which furthers this objective. For this reason there is constant repetition so that these events can sink into the hearts and minds of listeners and they become attentive towards them. This sinking in and attentiveness can only be achieved if the same event is repeated in various ways and styles whereby sleeping faculties are woken up.

The Qur'ānic stories and events deal mostly with previous nations and the Messengers of Allah (*Alaihimus*

Salām) who were sent to them and bit by bit other matters also become included there-in, mostly dealing with the arguments over good and bad and the battles between the friends of Allah and the friends of *Shaitan*, which in itself proves to be a great lesson and admonishment for me.

But, leaving others aside, there are today so few Muslims who derive benefit from Allah's last and perfect law-book, the Qur'ān, to fill our hearts with *Iman* and *Yaqeen*. After all it is Allah's law and we are commanded to implement its orders in our lives, Moreover we are required to ponder over its meanings as this Qur'ān is the means forwards acquiring success and salvation in both this world and the here after.

At the time of the Revelation of the Qur'ān, the Messenger of Allah became so distressed and defected at the enmity and opposition of the polytheists that he raised this complaint to Allah:

(5:25—30)

However, in this 15th century, if we should examine our hearts, we will find that in spite of our claims to be Muslims and believing the Qur'ān to be the word of Allah, how few are who have made this word of Allah the pattern for their lives and the model on which to base their lives, who read and recited with this aim in mind?

It was my aim, seeing this condition of my people and myself, to translate this great source of admonition into Urdu so that by presenting the translated version, the hearts of people will automatically become drawn to the original i.e., the Qur'ān and thereby acquire everlasting happiness.

In spite of my simple style of writing, care has been taken to confine myself to a few special points.

- (a) In this book the basis for all the stories is the Holy Qur'ān and the authentic *Hadith* and these have been further elucidated with historical facts.
- (b) Where there appears any contradiction or differences in the stories as told in the old testament and the Qur'ān, then with clear arguments an effort has been made either to reconcile the versions or with clear arguments to prove the truth as is expounded in the Qur'ān.
- (c) An effort has been made to point out the nonsensical Israili stories and where there have been nonsensical objections from enemies, these have in the light of the true facts been made clear for what they are.
- (d) In some special places there have been introduced some discussions on matters of disputes in *Tafseer* and *Hadith* and after discussing these the views of the saintly elders have been mentioned as a solution.
- (e) The facts concerning every Prophet ﷺ and in which chapter of the Qur'ān they are mentioned, has been gathered in one place.
- (f) Lastly, together with all the above points, a special heading of "Results and lessons", is introduced, giving the actual objective of this book and its main purpose viz., admonition and warning. Special attention is drawn to this aspect.

Servant of the Millat

Muhammad Hifzur Rahman Seoharwy

22 Rajab, 1360 Hijri

Translator's Foreword

For me as the translator of this book by Maulana Hifzur Rahman is a great honour. Throughout my student days in Darul Uloom Deoband in India, Maulana Hifzur Rahman or as we know him then as the *Mujahid-e-Millat* was one of the most respected leaders of the Muslim community. We used to flock to listen to his most interesting lectures. And as the general secretary of the *Jamiatul-Ulama*, and a M.P. he was also a great 'Alim (scholar) as can be gauged from this book *Qasasul Ambiya* (Tales of the Prophets) which entailed great research. I can remember whenever the students were confronted with any problem in the lives of any of the prophets, they always took refuge in Maulana's book for answers. I took upon it as a great honour in being in some small manner associated with Maulana's scholarship, even though this is an abridged version of the original book. But I must also state that I found great difficulty in translating this book because of the exceptionally high quality of the Urdu language used in the book.

I hope that the English translation of Maulana Hifzur Rahman's scholarly work will also be of great benefit to the English-speaking people. I just hope that I have been able to do justice to the original thoughts of the author.

Yusuf Karaan
Strand, South Africa